

SHRSS AEMaaCS Authoring Best Practices Volume (Authors & Site Owners)

SHRSS Authoring Best Practices Volume

For business authors, site owners, and power users

0. What This Volume Adds Beyond the Authoring Guide

You already have the **SHRSS AEM Content Authoring Guide** with how-to steps for Jobs, Events, Careers, News, Locations, Shared Data, etc.

This volume adds:

- **Patterns and anti-patterns** from real-world AEM usage.
- “If you do X, Y will happen”–style guidance for:
 - Core Components.
 - Content Fragments.
 - Tags, filters, and navigation.
- Practical workflows that keep Jobs/Events/News/Locations consistent across environments and over time.

Reference docs that underpin SHRSS authoring:

- [Content Fragments](#)
 - [Working with Content Fragments - Concepts and Best Practices](#)
 - [Authoring Content Fragments](#)
 - [The AEM Page Editor](#)
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1. Authoring Mindset for SHRSS

1.1 Pages vs Content Fragments vs Assets

- **Pages** – layout and experience:

- Think “what the visitor sees at a URL”.
- Built from components (cards, carousels, teasers, lists).
- **Content Fragments (CFs)** – reusable records:
 - Jobs, Events, News, Promotions, Locations, Venue.
 - One CF can power multiple pages and listings.
- **Assets (DAM)** – media:
 - Images, PDFs, video clips.
 - Linked from CFs and components.

Golden rule:

Change facts in CFs; change presentation on pages.

2. Jobs – Deep Dive Tips

This builds on §2 of your authoring guide.

2.1 Think in “sources”

- **Workday jobs:**
 - Don’t fight Workday. If a field is Workday-controlled:
 - Expect it to be overwritten on sync.
 - Treat it as read-only.
- **Manual jobs:**
 - Use when:
 - The role is not in Workday (e.g., local hiring events or temporary roles).
 - You need a marketing-only variant (but keep this rare).

Best practice:

- Use tags and shared taxonomy consistently across both Workday and manual jobs so that filters behave predictably.

2.2 Robust job listing behavior

When configuring job list components:

- Always check:
 - **Filter config vs tags:**

- If the component is configured for “job category = Food & Beverage” and no jobs have that tag, your list will be empty.
- **Date windows:**
 - If the list hides expired jobs based on a date field, confirm Workday is populating these correctly.

Scenario: “My job is in Workday but not on the site”

1. Confirm the **Job CF exists** and is published.
2. Check **tags and category:**
 - Does it match the list filters?
3. Check **Is API Data** and Workday status:
 - Closed or expired jobs might be filtered out.

2.3 Avoiding subtle issues

- **Do not clone Workday jobs** to create local variants; instead:
 - Create a **manual CF** with clear naming and tags; link to it explicitly from content.
 - Use the **Hot job flag sparingly:**
 - If everything is hot, nothing is hot.
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3. Events – Calendars That Don’t Surprise You

3.1 Single source of truth for events

- Use Event CFs as the **master record** for:
 - Title, description.
 - Date/time and location.
 - Status (scheduled, cancelled, postponed).
- Use **status** to communicate changes; avoid deleting events unless they were mistakes.

3.2 Calendar behavior patterns

For event listings/calendars:

- Treat:
 - **Date range filters** as your main control (e.g., show next 90 days).
 - **Tags** for “type” and “location” as secondary filters.

Tip: keep folder structure (/year/month) tidy but remember the calendar queries by **fields**, not folder names.

3.3 How to handle cancellations & reschedules

- When an event is cancelled:
 - Set status to **Cancelled**.
 - Set a short **status message** (e.g., "Event cancelled – refunds available at the box office").
 - Keep the CF and its page published so:
 - SEO links and bookmarks don't 404.
 - Visitors see the up-to-date status.
 - When rescheduled:
 - Update dates and status.
 - Add a status message like "Rescheduled from May 3 to June 10".
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4. News – Avoiding "Ghost Stories"

4.1 Publishing windows

For News CFs/pages:

- Always set:
 - **Publish date** – when should this become visible?
 - **Expiry date** – when does it stop being relevant?
- Ensure listing components understand:
 - Whether they should hide expired items or show them in an archive.

4.2 Cross-linking

Use News to:

- Link to relevant Jobs, Events, Locations:
 - Job spotlight stories link to Job detail pages.
 - Event recaps link to Event and Location pages.
 - Use **tags** as your cross-section:
 - A tag like **brand:XYZ** can unify Jobs, Events, News, and Promotions.
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5. Locations & Shared Data – Getting Filters Right

5.1 Location Content Fragments

Locations are the backbone:

- Pages:
 - Use Location CFs to display address, contact info, amenities, maps.
- Events:
 - Reference Location CFs for venue information.
- Jobs:
 - Link to Locations for “workplace” context.

Best practice:

- When a property changes (e.g., rebranding, address tweaks):
 - Update the **Location CF** first.
 - Let Jobs/Events/News that reference it inherit the change automatically.

5.2 Shared Data & navigation

Shared Data CFs & tags drive:

- Navigation menus.
- Filters on listings.
- Labels and groupings on cards.

Authoring habit:

- When a new “thing” is introduced (brand, property type, major category):
 - Create/adjust Shared Data CFs and tags **before** using them in Jobs/Events/News.
 - Update any navigation components that rely on hard-coded lists.
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6. Page Templates & Core Component Tips

6.1 Using templates well

For each template:

- Know its intended use:

- Home vs section landing vs listing vs detail.
- Avoid:
 - Creating serious one-off structures on pages that should instead become **templates or experience fragments**.

6.2 Core Components day-to-day tips

Using the Page Editor and Core Components:

- [The AEM Page Editor](#)

Practical patterns:

- **Teaser + CF:**
 - Use Teaser components referencing CF media/links to avoid duplicating text and images.
 - **List components:**
 - Whenever a list component offers:
 - “Fixed list” vs “Query-based list”, favor **query-based** when content is structured and tagged well.
 - **Experience Fragments:**
 - Use for repeated combos:
 - Hero banner + CTA.
 - “Visit us” panel with location info.
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7. Media & Assets – Author-Side Best Practices

Backed by:

- [Organize your digital assets](#)
- [Manage metadata of your digital assets](#)

7.1 Picking the right images

- Use consistent aspect ratios for:
 - Job cards.
 - Event cards.
 - Location tiles.
- When CFs ask for an image:

- Prefer **folder-specific, well-named assets** (e.g.,
/content/dam/shrss/locations/<property>/hero.jpg).
- Avoid:
 - Random one-off uploads scattered in the DAM – they are hard to maintain.

7.2 Metadata & tags on assets

- At minimum, always set:
 - **Title** and **Description**.
 - Relevant **tags** (brand, property, content type).
 - This improves:
 - Search inside AEM.
 - Future reuse.
 - Consistency with CF filters.
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8. Navigation & Data Display – Author Levers

Navigation and data display components are powerful but can be brittle if mis-configured.

8.1 Safe patterns

For navigations:

- Use **Page properties** (hide in navigation, title) consistently:
 - Don't "hide" by deleting or unpublishing pages.
- Build navigation using:
 - Root path + depth.
 - "Include/exclude by template" when applicable.

For data display (e.g., "jobs near me" or "events this weekend"):

- Always define:
 - Time windows.
 - Max items.
 - Fallback behavior (e.g., show generic promo if no events).
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9. Governance, Translation & Lifecycle

9.1 Workflow basics

When your org uses workflows:

- Use them for:
 - High-impact pages (home, key campaigns).
 - Legal/brand-sensitive news releases.
- Check your workflow tasks:
 - Don't leave items stuck in "review" states; this is a common source of "why didn't this publish?".

9.2 Translation & multi-locale

For CF-heavy content:

- Work with content architects to:
 - Identify which CF fields are **translatable** and which are not (IDs, URLs, etc.).
 - Use language copies for:
 - Pages.
 - CFs, when multi-language is required.
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References

- [Content Fragments](#)
- [Working with Content Fragments - Concepts and Best Practices](#)
- [Authoring Content Fragments](#)
- [The AEM Page Editor](#)
- [Creating Pages](#)